

circumstances have changed – that they're single and have just changed income, or a couple who've just moved in together etc – and they need to recalibrate, or that they're a bit stuck trying to work towards their goals. Some people just don't know where to start. For others it's about identifying what their spending triggers are, and what's causing them to struggle with their emotions when it comes to money. The most common things are people who either overspend or struggle to spend anything at all.'

Ellie's simplest tip for anyone wanting to address their relationship with money is just to get started. 'Don't expect it to be a quick process. Understanding, evaluating and shifting your relationship with money can be a long process. A lot of people don't want to start because they think it will be too hard, or they expect everything to slot into place really quickly and give up when it doesn't. The key is just sitting down with yourself and addressing where you are right now, both emotionally and practically. Look at the big picture, collect all of the information and then you'll be in the best position to start making changes.'

It can be very difficult to open up about money, even to someone who we're paying to help us to work through our problems, but we do absolutely *have* to talk about it in order to break that barrier, that feeling of taboo that keeps us locked in unhelpful cycles of shame and regret. Therapy is supposed to be a safe space for us to discuss whatever is bothering us, to resolve issues from our pasts and forgive ourselves for our